

P1. The Fuel Shock Panel — a rapid-response household phone panel (flagship)

Question. How do coping, well-being and trust in the state change over the fuel shock cycle, and how does that path differ between public-sector, formal-private and informal households?

Why it’s important. The 19/21 September timing splits households by sector, and a second hike is likely in Oct–Dec. A panel that starts now captures the baseline, the October “cliff”, Boro and LDC graduation in one dataset. Nothing like it exists for Bangladesh’s 2022 hike.

Design. - **Sample:** 1,500–2,500 households across Dhaka, Chattogram, Gazipur/Narayanganj (RMG belt), Rangpur and Rajshahi (Boro, diesel irrigation) and one coastal district. The sample is stratified by the main earner’s sector: government / formal private (incl. RMG) / informal non-farm (incl. transport) / farm. It is recruited from an existing sampling frame if a partner lends one (BIGD, SANEM or a survey firm). Otherwise use random-digit dialling with quotas. - **Waves:** W0 now (baseline, by mid-Oct) → W1 Nov → W2 Jan → W3 Mar → W4 Jun 2027 (after the Boro harvest). Each is a 15–20 min CATI (phone) interview. - **Core modules:** - spending cuts, measured with a list of 12 items, each ranked 1st/2nd/3rd - food insecurity (FIES, 8 items) - transport mode, time and cost for the main commute - kerosene/lighting and study hours - borrowing - intra-household allocation (who ate less) - relative deprivation (comparison to government employees) - blame - trust in institutions - protest willingness and participation - Family Card receipt - **Embedded experiment in W0:** randomise the explanation shown before asking whether the hike is acceptable: (a) nothing, (b) “global oil prices doubled”, (c) “Tk 32/L of the price is government duty”, (d) “government employees just received a pay rise”. This measures how *framing* and *perceived fairness* shift acceptance, which is the moral-economy test.

Analysis. Panel fixed effects. Compare trajectories between sectors (difference-in-differences with sector × wave). Heterogeneity by gender of respondent and income tercile. Treatment effects for the framing experiment.

Outputs. A public dashboard updated after each wave, policy briefs timed before the Boro and budget decisions, and 2–3 papers (coping, relative deprivation, moral economy).

Budget (indicative). ~\$35–60k for 5 waves at ~\$4–6 per completed CATI interview, plus the analyst, the survey firm’s management fee and incentives (Tk 50–100 mobile top-up per wave).

Risk. Phone surveys under-represent the poorest and women. Mitigate with quotas, asking for women respondents specifically, and a small in-person top-up.